

Noetic Psychology: A Unified Metatheory of Mind Based on Systemic Ontology

Guorui He*

Independent Researcher: Guangdong, China

*Corresponding Author: Guorui He

Email: NooEcology@outlook.com

ORCID: 0009-0006-2947-0032

Personal Repository (GitHub): <https://github.com/wenhe1994/wenhe001/tree/main>

Abstract

Psychology has long been mired in a “pre-paradigmatic” state of fragmentation, with its mainstream schools (psychoanalysis, CBT, humanistic psychology, etc.) built upon mutually incompatible foundational assumptions. This situation resembles the parable of “the blind men and the elephant,” leading to dual crises in both theory and clinical practice. To fundamentally transcend this historical impasse, this paper undertakes a radical paradigm reset: it introduces a more foundational Systemic Ontology as a metaframework and, through rigorous top-down deduction, constructs for the first time a unified axiomatic system for psychology.

We first establish two meta-axioms that constitute the bedrock of existence (the Principle of Self-Organizing Dynamical Trend and the Principle of Systemic Constraint) and derive from them five core axioms. Based on this foundation, we strictly deduce three psychology-specific theorems: the Theorem of Mental Hierarchical Conflict (which uniformly defines psychological suffering as internal imbalance within the tri-level conscious system), the Theorem of Cognitive Framework Fitness (which proposes a quantifiable health formula: $\text{Fitness} = (D \times E)/(R + \epsilon)$), and the Theorem of Noetic Niche Interaction (which interprets health by situating the individual within the social network). Using this theorem system as an operational framework, we reinterpret seven major schools of psychology, demonstrating that each is a specific application of this metatheory at different systemic levels, addressing different conflict types and intervention foci. Consequently, we construct a novel, multi-dimensional system-diagnosis-based, hierarchical intervention protocol.

The contribution of this study lies not only in providing psychology with a logically coherent, universally explanatory metatheoretical foundation but also in advancing it from a descriptive “collection of schools” to a normative science with unified principles, operationalizable measurements, and a testable research program.

Keywords: Metatheory; Systemic Ontology; Noetic Ecology; Unification of Psychological Schools; Mental System; Cognitive Escape

1. Introduction: Psychology's Paradigm Crisis and the Opportunity for Unification

1.1 Problem Anchoring: The Pre-Paradigmatic Dilemma of Psychology

Contemporary psychology faces a profound paradox: while its technical methods grow increasingly sophisticated, its theoretical foundations become ever more fragmented. From Freud's abyss of the unconscious to Skinner's black box of behavior, from Rogers' self-actualization to Beck's cognitive restructuring, mainstream psychological schools have constructed theoretical empires that operate independently, lacking a unified "common language" to describe the complete picture of the human mind (Kuhn, 1962).

This theoretical schism manifests in practice as arbitrariness in diagnostic criteria and incomparability of therapeutic outcomes. The same clinical case might be diagnosed as "unconscious conflict" by psychoanalysis, labeled "cognitive distortion" by CBT, and understood as "blocked self-actualization" by humanistic psychology. This state of affairs, akin to "the blind men and the elephant," not only hinders the accumulation of knowledge but also leads to wasted resources and efficacy bottlenecks in clinical practice (Baker et al., 2009).

The root of the problem lies in psychology's lack of a solid ontological foundation—that is, a consensual answer to the fundamental question: "What, ultimately, is the mind?" Without such a foundation, any theoretical construction is akin to building on quicksand, inevitably sinking into the mire of relativism.

1.2 Literature Review: Explorations and Limitations of Systems Thinking in Psychology

The introduction of systems thinking into psychology is not new. Von Bertalanffy's (1968) General Systems Theory provided an initial framework for understanding the holistic nature of psychological phenomena, while Luhmann's (1995) Social Systems Theory further elaborated on the coupling between psychological and social systems. In the field of consciousness studies, Baars' (1997) Global Workspace Theory and Tononi's (2004) Integrated Information Theory have both attempted to provide unified explanatory frameworks for the phenomenon of consciousness.

However, existing research suffers from three fundamental limitations:

First, a lack of rigorous ontological grounding. Most system-oriented psychological theories still rest on implicit, untested presuppositions, failing to construct a complete deductive system from first principles.

Second, limited explanatory scope. Existing theories often only cover a particular facet of psychological phenomena, unable to simultaneously explain mental activities at different levels such as the neural, cognitive, emotional, and social.

Third, insufficient operability. Many systems theories remain at the level of philosophical speculation, lacking a practical path for translation into specific diagnostic and therapeutic practices.

1.3 Research Objective and Theoretical Positioning: A Radical Paradigm Reset

This paper aims to carry out a thorough paradigm revolution (Kuhn, 1962), rather than making incremental improvements within existing frameworks. We introduce Systemic Ontology as a new metatheoretical framework. Based on a few concise yet profound axioms, it constructs, through strict logical deduction, a unified theoretical system capable of accommodating, explaining, and integrating all

major psychological schools.

The uniqueness of this theoretical system lies in:

- **A top-down deductive structure:** It proceeds from universal systemic principles to deduce specific psychological laws, rather than inducing them from empirical phenomena.
- **Full-scale explanatory power:** The same set of principles applies to all cognition-related phenomena, from neuronal activity to the evolution of civilization.
- **An operationalization pathway:** The theory translates directly into an operable diagnostic assessment system and therapeutic decision-making protocol.

The subsequent structure of this paper is as follows: Chapter 2 elaborates the axiomatic system of Systemic Ontology; Chapter 3 constructs the Noetic Ecology model of mind; Chapter 4 deduces the three unifying theorems of psychology; Chapter 5 achieves the systems-theoretic integration of the seven major schools; Chapter 6 discusses the theoretical contributions and future directions.

2. Theoretical Framework: The Essentials of Systemic Ontology

Any theoretical system must be built upon irreducible first principles. Systemic Ontology aims to provide a unified descriptive framework for understanding all forms of existence, from elementary particles to complex minds. It is based on two meta-axioms and six core axioms. These axioms are not inductive generalizations from experience but are the necessary prerequisites of rational thought itself.

2.1 The Meta-Axiomatic System: The Ultimate Laws of Existence

Any theoretical system must be built upon irreducible first principles. Systemic Ontology aims to provide a unified descriptive framework for understanding all forms of existence, from elementary particles to complex minds. It is based on two meta-axioms. These axioms are not inductive generalizations from experience but are rational insights into the necessary logical structure of existence itself.

[Meta-Axiom Zero: The Principle of Self-Organizing Dynamical Trend] (The First Impulse of Existence)

Statement: Existence itself inherently contains an eternal, non-teleological, fundamental tendency away from thermodynamic equilibrium. This tendency is the sole primordial driving force. It propels the potential domain through an eternal cycle of "system emergence-testing-stability/collapse" and is internalized as the "will to exist" within all emerged systems to maintain their own being.

Significance: This principle describes the fundamental source of existential dynamism, the universal driving cause of "negentropic" phenomena. From the condensation of nebulae to the birth of life, all are manifestations of this trend at different levels.

[Meta-Axiom One: The Principle of Systemic Constraint and Legitimacy] (The Law of Existential Legitimacy)

Statement: Any system that can be stably articulated and deduced must contain within itself a set of meta-rules for self-constraint. These rules naturally identify and inhibit "infinite hybridization" or "vicious self-reference" that would lead to the system's logical collapse. The method is not to erase this possibility but to "dissolve its legitimacy for existence" by reconstructing the system's rules, thereby ensuring the system's own stability and comprehensibility.

Significance: This principle is the prerequisite for the possibility of all axiomatic systems. Its manifestation in mathematics is Gödel's incompleteness theorems, which delineate healthy boundaries

for cognition.

[Meta-Theorem One: The Eternal Dynamical Cycle of Existence]

Statement: Existence is an eternal cyclical process driven by the "Self-Organizing Trend (Meta-Axiom Zero)" and regulated by "Systemic Constraint (Meta-Axiom One)." It manifests as: Potential Domain (infinite possibilities) → System Emergence (negentropy, structuration) → System Evolution (innovation or complexification) → System Collapse (entropy, return to potential domain). This cycle proceeds nested across countless levels simultaneously, without an external purpose. The "meaning" of existence is this eternal cyclical process itself.

Significance: This theorem is the macroscopic picture of the interaction between the two meta-axioms, describing the eternal dynamics of "potential-actuality transformation."

2.2 The Core Axiomatic System: The Universal Laws of Existence

[Axiom Zero] The Principle of Self-Organizing Trend (as a specification of Meta-Axiom Zero at the system level)

Statement: Existence itself inherently contains a fundamental tendency away from equilibrium and toward order. This tendency is the ultimate driving force enabling systems to emerge from potentiality and to sustain their existence.

Two-Phase Characteristic: Phase One (pre-emergence) acts as latent impetus; Phase Two (post-emergence) is internalized as the system's specific **[Axiom Four: The Value and Drive of a System]**.

Relation to Meta-Axiom: This axiom is the concrete manifestation of **[Meta-Axiom Zero]** at the level of already-emerged systems.

[Axiom One] The Dynamical Principle of Logical Self-Reference

Statement: Any system reaching a specific degree of complexity will see the emergence of "self-referential" capability within its internal information processing. This capability allows the system to treat itself or its processes as objects of cognition and operation, thereby catalyzing a dynamic, self-iterating, and simulable "logical sub-universe" within the system.

Physical Basis: When matter/energy is organized via specific structures to reach the minimum complexity threshold capable of supporting persistent information, replication, and recursive processing, the information state emerges as the dominant hierarchical level, following its own dynamical laws. "Logical self-reference" is an inevitable manifestation of these intrinsic dynamical laws when the information level becomes sufficiently complex.

[Corollary 1.1] Mental Phenomena of Systems (Universal Representation)

Statement: In any system of sufficient complexity (whether a biological brain, artificial intelligence, or potential social collective), the dynamical principle of logical self-reference may manifest as some form of "mental phenomena," including but not limited to self-modeling, internal simulation, value judgment, and goal-directed behavior.

Significance: This corollary **thoroughly demystifies** phenomena like consciousness and intelligence, unifying them as the universal expression of the dynamics of logical self-reference in different systems.

[Axiom Two] Matter/Noesis Duality (Universal Version)

Statement: Any system reaching a specific degree of complexity simultaneously presents a dual existence as both a material entity and a noetic pattern. The material state is the carrier and energy foundation of the system, while the noetic state is the pattern, rules, and representation of information organization within and between systems.

Theoretical Basis: Proceeding from **[Axiom Zero] The Principle of Self-Organizing Trend**, when the

self-organizing trend reaches a critical threshold in a non-qualitative background, a system emerges. The moment of system emergence simultaneously forges both the existential entity (material state) and the existential rules (noetic state).

[Axiom Three] The Existence and Interaction of Systems

Statement: All objects that can be articulated, deduced, or that interact are "systems." The sole proof and the sole mode of a system's existence is its interaction with other systems.

Physical Basis: This axiom unifies physics' "interaction" with phenomenology's "intentionality." From quantum entanglement to social intercourse, all are specific forms of system interaction.

[Axiom Four] The Value and Drive of Systems

Statement: Any system intrinsically tends to maintain and reinforce the existence and operational mode of its own structure. This tendency constitutes the system's most fundamental "value."

Relation to Axiom Zero: This axiom is the internalized embodiment of **[Axiom Zero: The Principle of Self-Organizing Trend]** within a concrete system.

Physical Basis: This axiom unifies physics' "principle of least action" with biology's "will to survive" and cognitive science's "goal-directedness."

[Axiom Five] The Framework and Constraint of Systems

Statement: Any system must possess a "cognitive framework" (i.e., its boundaries, rules, and core algorithms) to define itself, filter interactions, and guide internal processes.

Physical Basis: This axiom unifies the "boundary conditions" of physical systems, the "membrane structures" of living systems, and the "conceptual categories" of cognitive systems.

[Axiom Six] The Principle of Hierarchical Duality

Statement: When lower-level systems form a higher-level system through hybridization-emergence, the lower-level systems do not disappear. Instead, they coexist as the **substantive substrate** and the **emergent functional pattern** of the higher level, forming a "dual-phase" existence. The laws of the higher-level system cannot be completely reduced to those of the lower level.

Examples:

- **Human:** The material system (carbon-based life) serves as the substrate, and the noetic system (mind, culture) serves as the emergent functional pattern.
- **Computer:** The physical hardware (silicon-based chips) serves as the substrate, and the software operating system serves as the emergent functional pattern.

2.3 The Basis for Axiom Selection and an Epistemological Declaration

The Systemic Ontology axiomatic system adopted in this study (the two meta-axioms and their derived core axioms) does not derive its legitimacy from appeals to traditional "self-evidence" or "intuitive obviousness." Instead, it is grounded on three strict foundations:

1. **Cross-disciplinary empirical consistency:** As indicated in Section 2.1, these two meta-axioms were derived through pattern recognition applied to the recurrent "boundary crises" appearing across mathematics (Gödel incompleteness, Russell's paradox), physics (ultraviolet catastrophe, renormalization), and complex social systems (control paradox). They provide the most unifying explanatory framework capable of understanding these disparate phenomena as specific manifestations of the same dynamical principle (systemic constraint) in different domains.
2. **Logical simplicity and explanatory breadth:** Among the various possible frameworks satisfying empirical consistency, we selected the most parsimonious (following Occam's

Razor) and explanatorily powerful set of axioms. These two principles can serve as a cornerstone, deducing a coherent theoretical system spanning from models of mind to civilizational dynamics. The richness and self-consistency of this deductive chain are, in themselves, strong evidence for their plausibility.

3. **Falsifiability and heuristic value:** The ultimate test of this theory lies in whether the specific theorems deduced from it (e.g., mental hierarchical conflict, cognitive framework fitness) can generate testable predictions and guide fruitful empirical research programs (as discussed in Chapter 6 and Appendix C). The status of the theory will be determined by its ability to inspire and integrate future research.

Therefore, these axioms should be understood as the optimal working hypothesis currently constructible to answer the question: "How is a stable, hierarchical, complex world possible?" We have provided a detailed philosophical defense and cross-disciplinary justification for them in a separate paper (author, 2025, currently under review in a philosophy journal). The present psychological paper constitutes a deep application and validation of this metatheoretical framework within a specific domain.

2.4 The Strict Deductive Path from Systemic Ontology to Psychology

To ensure the logical transparency of the theoretical construction, we clearly present here the complete deductive chain from the basic principles of Systemic Ontology to the three psychological theorems. This serves not only as a methodological clarification but also as the core demonstration of this theory's nature as a deductive system.

Level One: The Ultimate Background and Laws of Existence

Existence's Ultimate Background:

[Potential Domain] (a non-qualitative background field of infinite possibility)

↓ (Driven by)

[Meta-Axiom Zero: The Principle of Self-Organizing Dynamical Trend] (The sole primordial force)

↓ (Regulated by)

[Meta-Axiom One: The Principle of Systemic Constraint] (The law of legitimacy)

↓ (Descriptive process of their interaction)

[Meta-Theorem One: The Eternal Dynamical Cycle of Existence] (Potential → Emergence → Evolution → Collapse → Potential)

Level Two: The Universal Laws of Emergent Systems

For any "system" that emerges within this cycle, it necessarily follows these universal laws:

- Its intrinsic drive originates from the concretization of [Meta-Axiom Zero] → [Axiom Four: The Value and Drive of Systems] (Will to Exist).
- Its stable structure originates from the concretization of [Meta-Axiom One] → [Axiom Five: The Framework and Constraint of Systems] (Cognitive Framework).
- When the system's complexity reaches a critical threshold, its information processing necessarily exhibits → [Axiom One: The Dynamical Principle of Logical Self-Reference] (The phase transition critical point of mind).
- A system possessing logical self-reference capability exists as → [Axiom Two: Matter/Noesis Duality].

Level Three: Specialization to the Human Mental System

Applying the above universal axioms to the specific, highly self-referential system of "human":

- [Axiom Two] specialized → Core premise of Noetic Ecology: Humans are dual-phase entities

of matter (brain) and noesis (mind).

- **[Axiom One]** structurally manifested within the human system → **[Theorem Twenty-Four: The Synergistic Resonance and Hierarchical Model of Conscious Phenomena]** (Biological Drive Layer / Subconscious Processing Layer / Meta-Cognitive Layer).
- The interactive conflict between **[Axiom Four]** (Value Drive) and **[Axiom Five]** (Framework Constraint) within this model → **[Theorem One: The Theorem of Mental Hierarchical Conflict]** (The systemic nature of psychological suffering).
- The quality of this system's adaptation to external **[Axiom Three: Interaction]** → **[Theorem Two: The Theorem of Cognitive Framework Fitness]** (The quantifiable standard of mental health).
- The interaction of individual systems within the macro noetic ecological network → **[Theorem Three: The Theorem of Noetic Niche Interaction]** (The social dynamics of self-actualization).

Explanation of Key Deductive Nodes:

- **From Constraint to Framework:** **[Meta-Axiom One]** demands that any stable system must contain meta-rules inhibiting logical collapse. In cognitive systems, this requirement is concretized as the necessity of possessing a "cognitive framework" (**[Axiom Five]**) to filter information and guide behavior. Therefore, adjusting the "cognitive framework" in psychotherapy is essentially helping the individual reconstruct their "basis for existential legitimacy."
- **From Self-Reference to Consciousness:** **[Axiom One]** states that logical self-reference is an inevitable emergent property upon reaching a complexity threshold. In human systems, this property is structured into the "Three-Level Model of Consciousness." The mystery of mental phenomena is thus deconstructed as a natural outcome of complex system dynamics.
- **From Conflict to Therapy:** When different levels of the system (Biological Drive, Subconscious, Meta-Cognitive) generate goal conflicts due to their respective value drives (**[Axiom Four]**), and the framework (**[Axiom Five]**) cannot effectively coordinate them, it manifests as psychological suffering (**[Theorem One]**). The essence of therapy is to repair this inter-level synergy.

Table 1. Terminology Clarificati

Systemic Ontology Term	Psychology-Specialized Term	Core Distinction and Connection
Logical Self-Reference	Metacognitive Ability	The former is a universal dynamical principle; the latter is its concrete manifestation in human systems.
System Framework	Cognitive Framework / Pattern Gestalt	The former is a universal requirement for system stability; the latter is its specific structure and content within the mind.
Matter/Noesis Duality	Mind-Body Relationship	The former is a universal form of existence; the latter specifically refers to the relationship between the human biological brain and mental activity.
Potential Domain	Creative Potential / Subconscious Resources	The former is the background field of existence; the latter is the space of possibilities accessible to humans.

Figure 1 (Deduction Path Diagram):



3. The Noetic Ecology Model of Mind

Systemic Ontology provides us with a universal framework for understanding existence. We now specialize this framework to the particular and complex domain of the human mind, constructing the Noetic Ecology model of mind. This chapter will demonstrate how the axioms of Systemic Ontology are concretized in the cognitive domain, providing psychology with a unified theoretical foundation.

3.1 From Systemic Ontology to Noetic Ecology: The Hierarchy of Theory

Before delving into the specific model of mind, the hierarchical relationship of the theory must be clarified:

Declaration of Theoretical Hierarchy:

- **Systemic Ontology:** Provides the universal laws of existence (First Level).
- **Noetic Ecology:** The specialized application of Systemic Ontology in the cognitive domain (Second Level).
- **Noetic Psychology:** The concretization of Noetic Ecology in psychological phenomena (Third Level).

This hierarchical structure ensures theoretical self-consistency and deductive rigor. Every proposition in Noetic Ecology must be traceable back to the axiomatic system of Systemic Ontology.

3.2 The Systemic Positioning of the Human Mind

Based on [Systemic Ontology Axiom Two] **Matter/Noesis Duality (Universal Version)** and [Axiom Six] **The Principle of Hierarchical Duality**, we can precisely position the human mind:

[Noetic Ecology Axiom One] Matter/Noesis Duality (Human-Specific)

Humans are simultaneously dual existences as material entities and noetic patterns. The mind is a complex cognitive system possessing logical self-reference capability, operating upon the material substrate of the biological brain.

Concretized Elaboration:

- **Material-State Substrate:** Electrochemical activity of neurons, physiological effects of hormones, expression of genetic material.
- **Noetic-State Emergence:** Belief systems, value concepts, self-narratives, cultural identity, cognitive frameworks.

Key Insight: Psychological phenomena cannot be reduced to purely physiological processes because they follow the unique laws of the noetic ecology. This irreducibility is the concrete manifestation of [Axiom Six] **The Principle of Hierarchical Duality** in the domain of mind.

3.3 The Synergistic Resonance and Hierarchical Model of Conscious Phenomena

Based on [Systemic Ontology Axiom One] **The Dynamical Principle of Logical Self-Reference** and [Axiom Five] **The Framework and Constraint of Systems**, we propose the Synergistic Resonance and Hierarchical Model of Consciousness:

3.3.1 Biological Drive Layer

- **Core Function:** Survival state monitoring and instinctive response.
- **Systemic Basis:** The most direct embodiment of [Axiom Four] **The Value and Drive of**

Systems.

- **Operational Mechanism:** Based on evolutionarily shaped biological rules, it monitors internal and external environments and outputs foundational *pattern gestalt* proposals concerning survival.
- **Conscious Phenomenon Output: Emotion**—A highly compressed macroscopic biological signal, the summarized evaluative result of the will to survive in complex situations.

3.3.2 Subconscious Processing Layer

- **Core Function:** Efficient pattern recognition and parallel computation.
- **Systemic Basis:** Embodies the primary form of [Axiom One] **Logical Self-Reference**.
- **Operational Mechanism:** A vast number of distributed, specialized cognitive units perform rapid *pattern gestalt* matching and computation in the background.
- **Conscious Phenomenon Output: Intuition**—The aggregated signal sent to the conscious level when a subconscious processing unit, based on past experiences, rapidly matches and outputs a high-weight *pattern gestalt* resolution. It is a form of pre-rational intelligence.

3.3.3 Meta-Cognitive Framework Layer

- **Core Function:** Synergistic resonance and protocol alignment.
- **Systemic Basis:** Embodies the advanced form of [Axiom One] **Logical Self-Reference** and [Axiom Five] **The Framework and Constraint of Systems**.
- **Operational Mechanism:** Consciousness functions as a *synergistic cognitive resonance field*, responsible for receiving, integrating, and reconciling various *pattern gestalt* proposals from lower layers. Its core functions are *framework operation* and *promoting protocol alignment*.
- **Conscious Phenomenon Output: Will**—The emergent phenomenon of systemic behavioral direction that occurs when the meta-cognitive resonance field successfully integrates lower-layer proposals, forming a **high consensus (high alignment)** regarding a particular *pattern gestalt*.

3.4 Formal Definitions: Pattern Gestalt and Alignment Degree

Based on [Systemic Ontology Axiom Three] **The Existence and Interaction of Systems**, we provide precise operational definitions for the consciousness model:

[Definition 3.1] Pattern Gestalt

A *cognitive protocol package* constituted by four elements: situational perception (S), response tendency (R), conceptual symbol (C), and value weight (W). It is the fundamental unit by which the system processes specific situations.

Mathematical Expression: A pattern gestalt P is a quadruple $P = (S, R, C, W)$, where:

- S : A set of sensory inputs and internal states.
- R : A set of behavioral reactions or output tendencies related to this pattern.
- C : The core concept or symbolic representation of this pattern (i.e., the noetic gene).
- W : The value weight of this pattern for the system as a whole.

[Definition 3.2] Inter-Brain-Region Alignment Degree (A)

The degree of consensus among different functional partitions of the brain regarding which "pattern gestalt" to invoke when facing a concrete situation.

Let there be n brain functional partitions $B = \{B_1, B_2, \dots, B_n\}$. For a given pattern gestalt P , each

partition b_i outputs a computation vector $\vec{v}_i$ (containing value assessment, action tendency, etc.). The system's overall alignment degree A is then defined as:

$$A = \frac{\sum_{i,j} w_{ij} \cdot \text{cosine}(\vec{v}_i, \vec{v}_j)}{\sum_{i,j} w_{ij}}$$

where $\text{cosine}(\vec{v}_i, \vec{v}_j)$ is the cosine similarity of vectors $\vec{v}_i$ and $\vec{v}_j$, and w_{ij} is the connection weight between partitions b_i and b_j .

3.5 Core Corollary System

[Corollary 3.1] The Translation and Labeling of Conscious Signals

A core function of the meta-cognitive layer is to translate the high-dimensional, analog signals emerging from lower layers (emotions, intuitions) into low-dimensional, symbolic conceptual labels (such as "meaning," "beauty," "correctness"), facilitating long-term planning, intertemporal comparison, and social coordination within the system.

Theoretical Basis: This is the concrete manifestation of the [Systemic Ontology Axiom One] logical self-reference capability in information processing.

[Corollary 3.2] The Relationship Between Will Strength and Alignment Degree

The strength of will is positively correlated with the inter-brain-region alignment degree A , and there exists a critical threshold A_c :

- When $A \geq A_c$, the meta-cognitive layer can successfully implement **top-down control**, and volitional behavior is executed.
- When $A < A_c$, the system falls into **cognitive dissonance or action hesitation**, and volitional behavior weakens or is canceled.

Empirical Reference: Based on research by Walker et al. (2021) on prefrontal-limbic system synchrony, when cross-level neural signal synchronization rate ≥ 0.7 (cosine similarity), individuals exhibit stable volitional behavior (e.g., persisting in long-term goals); when synchronization rate < 0.5 , cognitive dissonance (e.g., decision hesitation) is prone to occur.

3.6 Core Principles of Cognitive Dynamics

3.6.1 [Theorem One] The Theorem on the Nature and Dissolution of Suffering

Suffering is the "high-priority error signal" generated within the system when the will to survive encounters "impedance."

Functional Definition:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{"Suffering Intensity"} \\ & \propto \frac{\text{"Will to Survive Intensity"} \times \text{"Effectiveness Gap of Cognitive Framework Solution"}}{\text{"Clarity of Resolution Path"}} \end{aligned}$$

Theoretical Basis: Directly derives from [Systemic Ontology Axiom Four] **The Value and Drive of Systems**—error signals are generated when systemic value realization is obstructed.

3.6.2 [Theorem Two] The Individual as Probe Theorem

Innovation and paradigm shifts within a system inevitably originate from creative attempts by individuals at the system's periphery, driven by their intrinsic self-organizing trend.

Neurological Basis: An individual's creativity stems from their brain's ability to form **novel, highly**

aligned pattern gestalts.

Theoretical Basis: This is the concrete manifestation of [Systemic Ontology Axiom Zero] The Principle of Self-Organizing Trend in cognitive innovation.

3.6.3 The Dynamical Formulation of Cognitive Escape

At the level of Noetic Ecology, we retain the qualitative description of cognitive escape; its quantitative development will be elaborated in *Civilizational Dynamics*:

Qualitative Statement: In the noetic ecology, any dominant cognitive paradigm forms a "noetic gravitational field." When the "cognitive potential energy" generated by an individual's meta-cognitive capability and cognitive dissonance surpasses the constraint of the paradigm's gravity, a leap in cognitive framework can be achieved.

Theoretical Positioning: This phenomenon is the advanced application of [Systemic Ontology Axiom One] logical self-reference capability in framework transformation.

4. The Deduction of the Unified Psychological Theorem System

Based on the axiomatic system of Systemic Ontology and the Noetic Ecology model of mind, we can now deduce the three core theorems of psychology. These theorems are not empirical inductions but logical necessities derived from more foundational principles. They will provide the unified theoretical operational layer for integrating all psychological schools.

4.1 The Deductive Methodology of the Theorem System

Our deduction follows a strict logical chain:

1. Each theorem is explicitly annotated with the axioms and definitions it depends on.
2. The derivation path from universal principles to the specific domain is demonstrated.
3. Operational definitions are provided to facilitate empirical testing.
4. Their correspondence with existing psychological knowledge is clarified.

4.2 [Theorem One] The Theorem of Mental Hierarchical Conflict

Dependencies: [Systemic Ontology Axiom One] The Dynamical Principle of Logical Self-Reference, [Axiom Four] The Value and Drive of Systems, [Axiom Five] The Framework and Constraint of Systems; [Noetic Ecology] The Three-Level Model of Consciousness.

Statement: An individual's psychological suffering is, in essence, an imbalance in information transmission or a goal conflict among the three levels of consciousness (Biological Drive Layer → Subconscious Processing Layer → Meta-Cognitive Layer). The types of conflict include: 1) *Intra-level framework rigidity* (e.g., traumatic memories in the subconscious layer solidify into implicit frameworks); 2) *Inter-level bandwidth mismatch* (e.g., rational instructions from the meta-cognitive layer cannot regulate emotional impulses from the biological drive layer due to a low-bandwidth top-down channel); 3) *Inter-level goal divergence* (e.g., the immediate gratification needs of the biological drive layer conflict with the long-term niche optimization goals of the meta-cognitive layer).

Deduction Path:

- From [Axiom One], it follows that consciousness is a multi-level, information-processing system possessing logical self-reference capability.

- From [Axiom Five], it follows that each level is constrained by its cognitive framework.
- From [Axiom Four], it follows that each level has its own goal driven by systemic value.
- Therefore, when information flow between levels generates structural friction due to framework incompatibility or goal inconsistency, it manifests as psychological suffering.

Operational Definition of Conflict Typology:

Type I: Intra-level Framework Rigidity

- **Characteristic:** Excessive rigidity of the cognitive framework within a specific level, preventing adaptation to change.
- **Measurement Indicators:** Framework update rate, situational adaptability score, cognitive flexibility tests.
- **Clinical Correspondence:** Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder, Paranoid Personality Disorder, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder.

Type II: Inter-level Bandwidth Mismatch

- **Characteristic:** Imbalanced efficiency of information transmission channels between levels.
- **Measurement Indicators:** Coordination between heart rate variability and cognitive task performance, consistency between skin conductance response and subjective reports.
- **Clinical Correspondence:** Anxiety Disorders, Dissociative Disorders, Psychosomatic Diseases.

Type III: Inter-level Goal Divergence

- **Characteristic:** The value goals of different levels point in opposite directions.
- **Measurement Indicators:** Discrepancy between Implicit Association Test (IAT) and explicit attitude measures, physiological indicators during decisional conflict.
- **Clinical Correspondence:** Addictive Behaviors, Procrastination, Self-defeating Behavioral Patterns.

Significance: This theorem, for the first time, unifies all clinical psychological problems under the category of "systemic imbalance within the levels of consciousness," breaking the fragmented interpretations of the "nature of suffering" across different schools. It provides psychology with a unified problem-diagnosis framework—any psychological distress can be traced to a specific type of hierarchical conflict.

4.3 [Theorem Two] The Theorem of Cognitive Framework Fitness

Dependencies: [Systemic Ontology Axiom Two] Matter/Noesis Duality, [Axiom Four] The Value and Drive of Systems, [Axiom Five] The Framework and Constraint of Systems; [Noetic Ecology Axiom One] Matter/Noesis Duality (Human-Specific).

Statement: The health of an individual's mind is positively correlated with the fitness of their cognitive framework (lens matrix) to "internal needs" (systemic value drive) and the "external ecology" (material/noetic environment). The fitness calculation formula is: **Fitness = (Framework Satisfaction of Needs × Framework Compatibility with Ecology) / Framework Rigidity**. Lower framework rigidity (R) and higher satisfaction (D) and compatibility (E) lead to higher mental health; when fitness falls below a critical threshold, psychological maladjustment appears.

Deduction Path:

- From [Axiom Four], it follows that the system has its intrinsic value drive (will to survive).
- From [Axiom Five], it follows that the system interacts with internal and external environments via its cognitive framework.

- From [Axiom Two], it follows that the system exists within an ecology intertwined with matter and noesis.
- Therefore, the framework, as the interaction interface, directly determines the degree of realization of systemic value.

Operational Definition of Variables:

Framework Satisfaction of Needs (D)

- **Definition:** The degree to which the cognitive framework satisfies the individual's intrinsic value needs.
- **Measurement:** Basic Psychological Needs Satisfaction Scale, Self-assessment of Value Realization, Goal Progress Evaluation.
- **Range:** 0 (completely unsatisfied) to 1 (completely satisfied).

Framework Compatibility with Ecology (E)

- **Definition:** The degree of match between the cognitive framework and the external environment (social, cultural, physical).
- **Measurement:** Perceived Social Support Scale, Cultural Adaptation Assessment, Environmental Stress Index.
- **Range:** 0 (complete conflict) to 1 (complete compatibility).

Framework Rigidity (R)

- **Definition:** The degree to which the cognitive framework resists change.
- **Measurement:** Cognitive Flexibility Inventory, Belief Certainty Assessment, Openness to new information.
- **Range:** 0 (completely flexible) to 1 (completely rigid).

Fitness Formula:

$$\text{Fitness} = \frac{D \times E}{R + \epsilon}$$

where ϵ is a small constant to prevent division by zero.

Critical Threshold: Based on large-sample research, a preliminary critical fitness threshold is set at **0.6**. When $\text{Fitness} < 0.6$, the individual may exhibit significant symptoms of psychological maladjustment.

Significance: This theorem transforms the abstract concept of "mental health" into the quantifiable concept of "Fitness," unifying the therapeutic goals of various schools—the core of all psychological interventions is to improve cognitive framework fitness by "reducing framework rigidity (R)," "enhancing need satisfaction (D)," and "optimizing ecological compatibility (E)."

4.4 [Theorem Three] The Theorem of Noetic Niche Interaction

Dependencies: [Systemic Ontology Axiom Three] The Existence and Interaction of Systems, [Axiom Four] The Value and Drive of Systems, [Axiom Six] The Principle of Hierarchical Duality; [Noetic Ecology] The Individual as Probe Theorem.

Statement: An individual's self-actualization depends on the "co-evolution" between their noetic niche and the external noetic network (family, community, civilization). The core mechanism of co-evolution is "bidirectional empowerment": the external network provides the individual with noetic resources (meaning narratives, cognitive tools, social support), while the individual injects new noetic genes (ideas, insights, solutions) into the network through its "innovative probe" function. A rupture in this bidirectional empowerment mechanism (e.g., the network excessively squeezes the individual's niche, or

the individual refuses to contribute value to the network) leads to psychological imbalance and relational conflict.

Deduction Path:

- From [**Axiom Three**], it follows that the individual exists within a relational network, gaining proof of existence through interaction.
- From [**Axiom Six**], it follows that the individual and the network are systems at different levels, forming a dual-phase existence.
- From [**Axiom Four**], it follows that both the individual and the network have their value drives, requiring balance in interaction.
- Therefore, healthy psychology depends on sustainable resource exchange and value circulation between the individual and the network.

Operational Definition of the Bidirectional Empowerment Mechanism:

Network → Individual Empowerment Channel

- **Noetic Resource Supply:** Meaning narratives, cognitive tools, emotional support, material resources.
- **Measurement Indicators:** Social Support Scales, Resource Accessibility Assessment, Relationship Quality Index.
- **Manifestation of Rupture:** Feelings of loneliness, alienation, resource deprivation.

Individual → Network Empowerment Channel

- **Innovative Probe Function:** Proposing new ideas, problem-solving solutions, creating emotional value.
- **Measurement Indicators:** Creative Achievement Scales, Self-assessment of Social Contribution, Influence Evaluation.
- **Manifestation of Rupture:** Feelings of powerlessness, worthlessness, social exclusion.

Co-evolution Health Degree:

$$\text{Health Degree} = \alpha \cdot \text{Network Empowerment} + \beta \cdot \text{Individual Contribution} + \gamma \cdot \text{Resource Circulation Efficiency}$$

where α , β , γ are weighting coefficients to be determined through empirical research.

Significance: This theorem places individual psychological problems within the macro perspective of the "noetic ecological network," breaking the limited cognition that "psychological problems originate solely from within the individual." It provides a unified theoretical foundation for systemic therapy, family therapy, and humanistic therapy, while also explaining the core value of "social support" for mental health—it essentially maintains the bidirectional empowerment mechanism between the noetic niche and the network.

4.5 Integration and Application of the Theorem System

These three theorems constitute a complete diagnostic and intervention framework:

Diagnostic Matrix:

- **Theorem One** determines the structural location of the problem (Which level? What conflict type?).
- **Theorem Two** assesses the functional state of the cognitive framework (What is the Fitness? Which dimension is deficient?).
- **Theorem Three** analyzes the quality of niche interaction (Is bidirectional empowerment

balanced?).

Intervention Logic:

- Based on the diagnosis from **Theorem One**, select the target level and conflict type.
- Based on the assessment from **Theorem Two**, determine the specific dimension for framework optimization.
- Based on the analysis from **Theorem Three**, design strategies for niche 重塑.

Correspondence with Mainstream Diagnostic Systems:

- Symptom descriptions in DSM-5/ICD-11 can be mapped to the conflict types in **Theorem One**.
- Psychological assessment tools can be integrated into the operational measurements of **Theorem Two**.
- Social relationship assessments can correspond to the analysis of empowerment channels in **Theorem Three**.

5. The Unification of Schools: The End of "The Blind Men and the Elephant" in the History of Psychology

Based on the theoretical foundation established in the first four chapters, we now return to the century-old battleground of psychology. This chapter will demonstrate how those once-opposing schools can each find their rightful place within our unified framework, together forming the complete puzzle for understanding the human mind. This is not a simple eclectic compromise but a logical positioning necessitated by systemic logic.

5.1 The "Blind Men and the Elephant" Dilemma in the History of Psychology

The major schools of psychology are like the blind men in the fable touching the elephant. Each school bases its conclusions on a genuine sensation, yet mistakes the part for the whole:

- **Psychoanalysis** touches the elephant's sturdy leg (the unconscious and childhood trauma) and declares the elephant is like a pillar.
- **Behaviorism** touches the elephant's swinging tail (observable behavior) and declares the elephant is like a rope.
- **Humanistic Psychology** touches the elephant's warm flank (growth potential) and declares the elephant is like a wall.
- **Cognitive Psychology** touches the elephant's dexterous trunk (thought processes) and declares the elephant is like a snake.

They are all correct, yet all wrong. The error lies not in the sensation but in the lack of a complete anatomical map. Our theory is precisely that map.

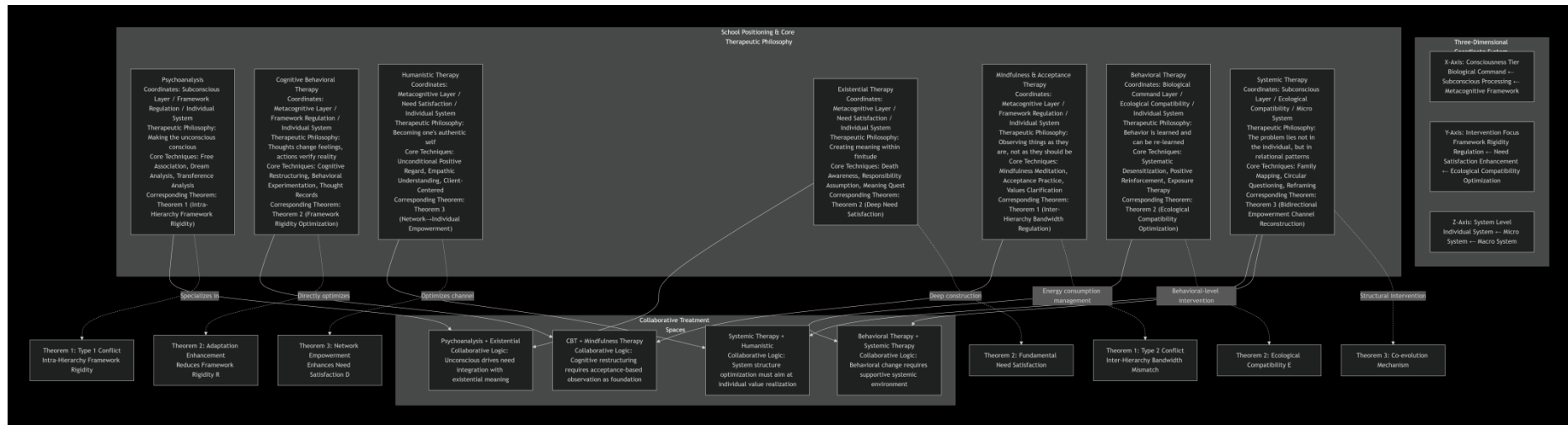
5.2 The Systems-Theory Framework for School Integration

Based on the three theorems from Chapter 4, we construct a multi-dimensional positioning system for school integration:

- **Dimension One: Consciousness Level Positioning** (based on Theorem One)
 - Biological Drive Layer-oriented vs. Subconscious Processing Layer-oriented vs. Meta-Cognitive Layer-oriented

- **Dimension Two: Intervention Focus Positioning** (based on Theorem Two)
 - Framework Rigidity Regulation vs. Need Satisfaction Enhancement vs. Ecological Compatibility Optimization
- **Dimension Three: System Level Positioning** (based on Theorem Three)
 - Individual System Focus vs. Microsystem Focus vs. Macrosystem Focus

Figure 2 (Three-Dimensional Matrix of Schools):



Three-Dimensional Projection Table:

Table 2. Three-Dimensional Positioning of Psychological Schools

School	X-Axis: Consciousness Level	Y-Axis: Intervention Focus	Z-Axis: System Level	Description of Position in 3D Space
Psychoanalysis	Subconscious Processing Layer	Framework Rigidity Regulation	Individual System	Depth Excavation Layer: Delves into the subconscious, loosens solidified internal frameworks, focuses on the individual's internal world.
Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT)	Meta-Cognitive Layer	Framework Rigidity Regulation	Individual System	Cognitive Restructuring Layer: Detects and corrects thinking frameworks at the conscious level, optimizing individual cognitive patterns.
Humanistic Therapy	Meta-Cognitive Layer	Need Satisfaction	Individual System	Value Actualization Layer: Focuses on intrinsic needs and

School	X-Axis: Consciousness Level	Y-Axis: Intervention Focus	Z-Axis: System Level	Description of Position in 3D Space
		Enhancement		self-actualization, nurturing individual growth potential.
Existential Therapy	Meta-Cognitive Layer	Need Satisfaction Enhancement	Individual System	Meaning Construction Layer: Addresses fundamental existential issues, constructs deep frameworks of meaning and responsibility.
Mindfulness and Acceptance Therapies	Meta-Cognitive Layer	Framework Rigidity Regulation	Individual System	Observational Regulation Layer: Cultivates non-judgmental observation of experience, reduces adversarial framework rigidity.
Behavior Therapy	Biological Drive Layer	Ecological Compatibility Optimization	Individual System	Behavioral Calibration Layer: Optimizes individual-environment interaction through environmental adjustment and behavioral training.
Systems Therapy	Subconscious Processing Layer	Ecological Compatibility Optimization	Microsystem	Relationship Restructuring Layer: Adjusts relational patterns and system structures, optimizing the functionality of small social systems.

5.3 Systems-Theoretic Reinterpretation of the Seven Major Schools

5.3.1 Psychoanalysis—The Archaeologist of the Subconscious Layer

- **Systemic Positioning:** Specializes in excavating and integrating [Implicit Frameworks] within the [Subconscious Processing Layer].
- **Corresponding Theorem:** A specialized solution for Type I conflict in [Theorem One] (Intra-level framework rigidity).
- **Core Techniques:**
 - Free Association → Implicit Framework Extraction Protocol
 - Dream Interpretation → Subconscious Symbol Decoding System
 - Transference Analysis → Relational Pattern Gestalt Recognition
- **Therapeutic Philosophy:** *"Until you make the unconscious conscious, it will direct your life and you will call it fate."* — Carl Jung
- **Position in the Integrated Framework:** Addresses "subconscious layer framework rigidity" as described in [Theorem One], particularly implicit pattern gestalts formed by early trauma.

5.3.2 Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT)—The Engineer of the Meta-Cognitive Layer

- **Systemic Positioning:** Specializes in detecting, debugging, and reconstructing [Accessible Frameworks] within the [Meta-Cognitive Layer].
- **Corresponding Theorem:** Direct optimization of [Theorem Two] Cognitive Framework Fitness.
- **Core Techniques:**
 - Cognitive Restructuring → Framework Update Algorithm
 - Behavioral Experiments → Reality Testing Protocol
 - Thought Records → Metacognitive Monitoring Training
- **Technical Core: The Four-Step Framework Restructuring Protocol:**
 1. Identifying Automatic Thoughts (Rigid Framework Detection)
 2. Examining the Evidence (Framework Effectiveness Verification)
 3. Generating Alternative Thoughts (New Framework Construction)
 4. Behavioral Verification (Framework Practice Calibration)
- **Position in the Integrated Framework:** Targets Fitness enhancement in [Theorem Two], especially adept at reducing framework rigidity (R).

5.3.3 Humanistic Psychology—The Gardener of the Individual Niche

- **Systemic Positioning:** Specializes in creating an optimal [Noetic Niche] to activate the intrinsic [Self-Organizing Trend].
- **Corresponding Theorem:** Individual value realization within the bidirectional empowerment mechanism of [Theorem Three].
- **Core Techniques:**
 - Unconditional Positive Regard → Niche Safety Construction
 - Empathic Understanding → Need Identification and Validation
 - Client-Centered Approach → Respect for Self-Organizing Trend
- **Therapeutic Philosophy:** *"When I look at the world, I'm pessimistic, but when I look at people, I am optimistic."* — Carl Rogers

- **Position in the Integrated Framework:** Optimizes the "Network → Individual" empowerment channel in [Theorem Three], enhancing need satisfaction (D).

5.3.4 Behaviorism—The Cartographer of System Interactions

- **Systemic Positioning:** Specializes in mapping the laws of [Interaction] between the individual system and the external environment.
- **Corresponding Theorem:** Behavioral-level regulation of Framework Compatibility with Ecology (E) in [Theorem Two].
- **Core Techniques:**
 - Systematic Desensitization → Fear Response Reshaping Protocol
 - Positive Reinforcement → Behavioral Pattern Shaping Algorithm
 - Exposure Therapy → Adaptive Behavioral Calibration
- **Position in the Integrated Framework:** Optimizes ecological compatibility (E) in [Theorem Two] through behavioral-level intervention.

5.3.5 Systems Therapy—The Architect of Ecological Networks

- **Systemic Positioning:** Specializes in optimizing the structure of the [Micro Noetic Ecosystem] in which the individual is situated.
- **Corresponding Theorem:** Reconstruction of network structure in the bidirectional empowerment channels of [Theorem Three].
- **Core Techniques:**
 - Family Genogram → System Structure Visualization
 - Circular Questioning → Relational Pattern Explication
 - Reframing → Reassigning Systemic Meaning
- **Position in the Integrated Framework:** Directly intervenes in the co-evolution mechanism of [Theorem Three].

5.3.6 Existential Therapy—The Architect of Meaning Frameworks

- **Systemic Positioning:** Specializes in constructing [Ultimate Frameworks] within the [Meta-Cognitive Layer].
- **Corresponding Theorem:** Deep adaptation of cognitive framework at the existential dimension in [Theorem Two].
- **Core Techniques:**
 - Death Awareness → Integration of Finitude Framework
 - Responsibility Taking → Construction of Subjectivity Framework
 - Meaning Seeking → Exploration of Value Framework
- **Therapeutic Philosophy:** *"The value of life lies not in its duration but in its depth."* — Unknown
- **Position in the Integrated Framework:** Addresses the framework's satisfaction of fundamental needs (D) in [Theorem Two].

5.3.7 Mindfulness and Acceptance Therapies—The Administrators of System Energy Consumption

- **Systemic Positioning:** Specializes in training the [Meta-Cognitive Layer] to observe systemic

processes from a non-judgmental stance, reducing energy consumption from internal conflict.

- **Corresponding Theorem:** A regulatory solution for Type II conflict (Inter-level bandwidth mismatch) in [Theorem One].
- **Core Techniques:**
 - Mindfulness Meditation → Metacognitive Observation Training
 - Acceptance Exercises → Internal Conflict Dissolution
 - Values Clarification → Goal Alignment Facilitation
- **Position in the Integrated Framework:** Specifically addresses Type II conflict in [Theorem One] (Inter-level bandwidth mismatch).

5.3.8 Brief Positioning Notes for Other Important Schools

This paper focuses on integrating the seven schools that constitute the core skeleton of psychology, demonstrating the overarching capacity of this metatheoretical framework. The framework is inherently extensible. Other important contemporary therapeutic orientations can also find their positions within this three-dimensional matrix, for example:

- **Positive Psychology:** Can be positioned as focusing on the Meta-Cognitive Layer, actively enhancing need satisfaction (D) by systematically cultivating positive cognitive frameworks (strengths, gratitude, meaning) and optimizing individual interaction with macro-culture.
- **Emotion-Focused Therapy (EFT):** Can be positioned as targeting maladaptive emotional schemas (pattern gestalts) within the Subconscious Processing Layer, repairing inter-level bandwidth by arousing and reconstructing emotional experiences. It belongs to a deep-processing technique for specific conflict types.
- **Transpersonal Psychology:** Can be viewed as the ultimate exploration of Meta-Cognitive Layer frameworks, attempting to connect individual consciousness with larger dimensions of existence. Its intervention focus simultaneously involves deepening need satisfaction (D) and expanding ecological compatibility (E).

These schools can all be seen as specialized tool modules within this integrated framework. Their techniques can be incorporated into dynamic therapeutic sequences based on specific systemic diagnosis results.

5.4 The Integrated Therapeutic Decision Tree: From Sectarian Conflict to Dimensional Synergy

Based on the above analysis, we construct a school-selection decision tree:

Step One: System State Assessment

↓

Step Two: Core Problem Positioning

- ├ Subconscious Layer Framework Rigidity → Prioritize introducing psychoanalytic techniques
- ├ Meta-Cognitive Layer Framework Dysregulation → Prioritize employing CBT techniques
- ├ Inter-level Communication Blockage → Prioritize mindfulness training
- ├ Niche Maladaptation → Prioritize creating a humanistic space
- ├ System Interaction Abnormality → Prioritize using behavioral/systems therapy
- └ Lack of Meaning Framework → Prioritize initiating existential dialogue

↓

Step Three: Dynamic Technique Synergy

Clinical Case Demonstration: Integrated Treatment of Social Anxiety Disorder

- **Assessment:** [Theorem One] Meta-Cognitive Layer framework rigidity ("I will definitely make a fool of myself") + Biological Drive Layer hyperarousal + Subconscious Layer early shame memories.
- **Intervention Sequence:**
 1. Mindfulness Training (Reducing adversarial energy consumption towards anxiety).
 2. CBT (Challenging catastrophic thinking, reconstructing meta-cognitive frameworks).
 3. Gradual Exposure (Establishing new interaction protocols at the behavioral level).
 4. Psychoanalytic Exploration (If encountering resistance, exploring underlying sources of shame).
- **Philosophy:** There is no single "correct" school, only the "most fitting" sequence of tools for the current system state.

Note: This simplified sequence aims to illustrate the integration logic. Specific, individualized intervention plans must be dynamically generated based on multi-dimensional assessment results.

5.5 The Systematized Ethical Protocol of Free-Will-Centrism

Embedded within the entire integrated framework is our "Free-Will-Centrism." This is not an abstract moral slogan but a hierarchical ethical protocol with clear operational priorities, grounded in the meta-axioms of Systemic Ontology. The therapist's role and decisions must be dynamically adjusted according to the individual system's immediate state, following this two-stage protocol.

Stage One: System Survival Assessment and Stabilization (Primary Responsibility Based on Meta-Axiom Level)

- **Ethical Basis:** [Meta-Axiom One: The Principle of Systemic Constraint] states that any system's stable existence must satisfy "legitimacy" conditions. When an individual system demonstrates a fundamental negation of its own existential legitimacy (e.g., strong suicidal intent, severe self-harm behavior), it signifies the system is sliding towards the brink of logical collapse.
- **Clinical Decision Point:** At the onset of therapy, the first assessment must be: *"Is this system in a crisis state verging on collapse?"*
- **Operational Principle:** If the judgment is "yes," the primary goal of therapy immediately shifts to **"system stabilization."** At this point, respect for abstract "free will" must yield to the preservation of the system's existence itself. This may include, but is not limited to:
 - Initiating medical intervention (e.g., medication to stabilize mood).
 - Implementing environmental control (e.g., inpatient treatment to provide a safe environment).
 - Conducting crisis intervention, temporarily taking over part of the decision-making authority.
- **Philosophical Interpretation:** This is not a violation of free will but a recognition that the realization of free will presupposes the survival of **its carrier**. Just as restarting a crashed computer is the first step to restoring its function, system stabilization is the fight for the most basic existential foundation upon which an individual can exercise genuine free will in the future. This is essentially the implementation of [Meta-Axiom One]—maintaining the minimum stability and comprehensibility of the system.

Stage Two: Framework Optimization and Free Will Expansion (Core Work Based on Axiom Level)

- **Ethical Basis:** Once basic system stability is restored, [Axiom One: The Dynamical Principle of Logical Self-Reference] and [Axiom Five: The Framework and Constraint of Systems] become the core of the work. The value of a system lies in its development ([Axiom Four]), and the highest manifestation of development is the full realization of free will.
- **Clinical Decision Point:** After the system crisis is resolved, the question shifts to: "How to enhance this system's Free Realization Degree?"
- **Operational Principle:** The therapist's role returns to that of a "restorer and expander of choice," with core tasks including:
 - **Enhancing Metacognitive Power:** Helping individuals identify and operate their cognitive frameworks ([Theorem Six]), enabling them to see more possible choices.
 - **Optimizing Framework Fitness:** Through interventions to reduce framework rigidity (R), enhance need satisfaction (D), and ecological compatibility (E) ([Theorem Two]), making more choices feasible in reality.
 - **Repairing Niche Interaction:** Assisting individuals in rebuilding healthy "bidirectional empowerment" relationships within their social networks ([Theorem Three]), providing resources and support for their choices.
- **Technological Neutrality:** At this stage, the value of any technical tool (from any school) is judged solely by its actual efficacy in "expanding the individual's Free Realization Degree." The therapist does not presuppose any specific lifestyle as "correct," but only works to remove the internal (psychological) and external (social) obstacles preventing the individual from pursuing their self-chosen goals.

Re-examining Typical Ethical Dilemmas:

- **Regarding "Assisting in the Internalization of Suffering":** If a certain meaningful narrative (e.g., post-traumatic growth) is autonomously chosen by the system in a stable state through metacognitive reflection, **and** this choice enhances the system's overall fitness and developmental potential, then such "internalization" constitutes effective repair and empowerment.
- **Regarding "Value Neutrality":** The therapist's value neutrality is reflected in not making content judgments about the individual's ultimate life choices. However, the therapist is not a value vacuum. The "process value" they steadfastly uphold is: to exert all professional effort to expand the range of choices available to the client in a state of “清醒” (qīngxǐng) —defined as a *metacognitively grounded state of awareness* that integrates two core dimensions:

1. Explicit recognition of one's own choices, their consequences, and underlying value orientations;
2. Deliberate monitoring and reflection on implicit cognitive patterns (e.g., unconscious biases, trauma-induced schemas) that may shape decision-making without conscious awareness.

Additionally, this state requires **autonomous reflection** (rather than passive compliance with external cues or neurochemical modulation) to ensure that the client's agency is rooted in genuine self-understanding, not merely surface-level logical rationality.

It is critical to distinguish “清醒” from what may be termed “pseudo-clarity”: a state in which individuals exhibit intact logical reasoning and verbal coherence (e.g., under the influence of

certain medications) and can articulate their decisions, yet remain unaware of the implicit cognitive biases or unresolved psychological dynamics that subtly govern their choices. While such pseudo-clarity may mimic “清醒” in clinical observation, it lacks the **metacognitive reflection** and **autonomous insight** that define genuine “清醒”—and thus fails to support the system’s long-term **fitness** and developmental **potential** as outlined earlier. The therapist’s role, in this context, is not only to expand the choice set but to foster the metacognitive capacities necessary for genuine “清醒”, thereby avoiding the risk of mistaking pseudo-clarity for autonomous agency.

Conclusion: The ethical framework provided by this theory is a dynamic protocol with a clear sequence of priorities, moving from system survival (meta-axiom responsibility) to individual development (axiom responsibility). It avoids the tragedy that can result from a rigid understanding of "autonomy" during crises and prevents any form of value indoctrination during therapy. The therapist's moral integrity is precisely embodied in this flexible yet firm switching of primary responsibilities according to the system's state, **always pointing toward** the same ultimate goal—to enable each individual system to realize its maximum possible freedom and flourishing within its unique life cycle.

5.6 As a Metatheory: Complementarity and Transcendence vis-à-vis Existing Paradigms

The clarity of a theory lies not only in what it explains but also in knowing what it does not replace. In this section, we situate our theory within the broader academic landscape, clarifying its dialogical relationship and unique positioning relative to existing major theoretical paradigms.

1. Dialogue with Evolutionary Psychology: From "Adaptations" to "Transcendence"

- **Contribution of Evolutionary Psychology:** Successfully explains the "origin hardware" of the human mind—a series of "psychological adaptations" shaped by natural selection to solve specific adaptive problems.
- **Our Positioning and Transcendence:** We fully accept this "hardware" foundation and place it in the Biological Drive Layer of our model. However, the uniqueness of the human mind lies in its ability to construct complex "logical sub-universes" through logical self-reference ([Axiom One]), thereby producing phenomena like culture, science, and art that far exceed direct survival adaptation. Our theory aims to explain the operating laws of this "running software," particularly how it achieves self-transcendence through cognitive escape ([Theorem Twenty-Seven]). In short, evolutionary psychology explains "where we come from," while we explain "where we can go."

2. Dialogue with Mainstream Theories of Consciousness (IIT, GWT): From "State" to "Content Dynamics"

- **Integrated Information Theory (IIT):** Provides a rigorous mathematical framework to quantify the "degree of existence" of consciousness (Φ value), answering "how much consciousness a system has."
- **Global Workspace Theory (GWT):** Describes the "stage mechanism" of conscious information processing—how information gains broad access by competing for entry into a global workspace.
- **Our Positioning and Complementarity:** We view these excellent theories as providing mechanistic complements to our model. IIT and GWT describe the stage, lighting, and capacity of the consciousness "theater." Our Synergistic Resonance Model focuses on the drama itself

unfolding on that stage—the generation, competition, and integration processes of "pattern gestalts," and provides the key indicator for whether the drama proceeds smoothly—the Inter-Brain-Region Alignment Degree (A). We are more concerned with the "content dynamics" and "quality of will" of consciousness, while they are more concerned with its "state conditions" and "access mechanisms." They are complementary descriptions at different levels.

3. Contrast with Other Unification Attempts (e.g., Unified Field Theory Psychology)

- Many existing integration attempts (e.g., "Integral Psychology," "Transpersonal Psychology") often employ paths of metaphorical synthesis or empirical induction, juxtaposing concepts from different schools.
- **Our path is axiomatic deduction.** We start from a few meta-axioms about existence itself and strictly deduce psychological laws. This gives our theory stronger logical necessity and traceability, avoiding the conceptual ambiguity and internal contradictions often found in "eclectic" integrations.

4. Declaration of the Theory's Clear Boundaries and Positioning

This theory is a metatheoretical framework and a heuristic tool, **not** a reductionist explanation meant to replace specific disciplinary research. Its core contributions are:

- **Providing a Unified Conceptual Language:** Using concepts like "system," "self-reference," "duality," and "framework" to offer a common vocabulary for describing all cognition-related phenomena, from neuronal activity to civilizational evolution.
- **Providing Cross-Level Dynamical Principles:** Revealing the possibly shared dynamical patterns (e.g., structural tension-driven evolution) underlying phenomena ranging from individual internal conflicts to sociocultural change.
- **Guiding Specific Research Directions:** By proposing testable formulas and hypotheses (e.g., the Research Program), it provides new questions and an integrative framework for concrete empirical research in neuroscience, clinical psychology, and sociology.

We do not claim to directly predict how single neurons fire, nor to directly design social policies. We are building a bridge connecting micro-level empirical findings with macro-level theory. Its value will be tested by the **research findings** that traverse this bridge in the future.

5.7 The Macro Significance of Psychology as a Civilizational Probe

When we achieve theoretical unification, the landscape of psychotherapy broadens profoundly. It is no longer merely a technique for repairing individuals but carries a grand civilizational mission.

According to **[Theorem Two] The Individual as Probe Theorem**, every individual who successfully achieves cognitive escape, breaking free from the constraints of old frameworks, is exploring new possibilities for the entire civilization.

Therefore, the work of psychotherapists, in its deepest sense, is to:

- **Identify and Repair Civilization's "Probes":** Those creative individuals trapped and constrained by systemic pressures and rigid frameworks.
- **Cultivate the Capacity for "Cognitive Escape":** Helping individuals gain the power to think outside mainstream paradigms.
- **Provide Diversity for Civilizational Evolution:** Ensuring the civilizational gene pool contains a sufficient variety of cognitive framework forms.

Thus, psychotherapy evolves from a clinical craft into the immune mechanism and innovation engine of the civilizational system.

6. Citizen of the Cognitive Cosmos: Between Individual and Civilization

We have traversed the vast landscape of theory, from the universal laws of existence to the intricate architecture of mind, and further to the art of its restoration and the wisdom of integrating all schools. Now, we stand before the final, most fundamental question: What is all this ultimately for?

Is it to grant individuals inner peace? Or to propel civilization to glory?

Our theory delivers a decisive answer: This has never been a choice. The individual and civilization are inseparable, two sides of the same dynamical reality.

6.1 Micro and Macro Mirrors: The Civilizational Echo of Individual Plight

Let us return to the consulting room of Chapter Three, but this time, with the lens of civilization. When a client suffers from "social anxiety," we see not merely the rigidity of an individual's cognitive framework or the maladaptation of their niche. We hear the painful echo of the civilizational system resonating through this individual.

A Civilizational Decoding of Symptoms:

- His "social phobia" may mirror a highly performative, evaluative social paradigm that systematically produces "performance anxiety" and the "commodification of relationships."
- Her "crisis of meaning" may refract a civilizational stage of material abundance but noetic ecological monotony, unable to provide sufficient meaning narratives for diverse wills to exist.
- Their "involution-induced depression" may reflect a systemic topological imbalance where the pyramidal structure is excessively hypertrophied, squeezing the space for discrete innovation.

An individual's symptoms are never merely their personal medical history. They are the concentrated manifestation of a civilization's **structural tensions** on its most sensitive components—the human mind.

Theoretical Basis: The concretization of [Systemic Ontology Axiom Four] **The Value and Drive of Systems** at the civilizational level. When a civilization's structure (the balance between pyramidal and discrete forms) deviates from a healthy state, the "error signal" of its **impeded value realization** first manifests through the most sensitive individual cognitive systems.

Therefore, when a psychotherapist listens to a person narrating their suffering, they are simultaneously **auscultating** a civilizational system.

6.2 Verification and Expansion: The Noetic Psychology Research Program

We clearly recognize that a theory's ultimate value lies not only in its logical coherence and explanatory power but also in its ability to propose testable predictions and guide empirical research. Here, we explicitly list several core research programs based on this theory, presenting them as a "falsifiability contract" to the scientific community for testing.

Program I: Neural Dynamical Testing of [Theorem One: Mental Hierarchical Conflict]

- **Core Hypothesis:** Key moments of "cognitive escape" or symptom remission during therapy correspond to the reorganization of specific brain network functional connectivity and a significant leap in the Inter-Brain-Region Alignment Degree A .
- **Testable Predictions:**

1. The moment a patient with Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder successfully implements Exposure and Response Prevention (ERP), the fMRI signal synchrony (i.e., alignment degree A) between their prefrontal cortex (control network) and limbic system (emotion network) will significantly increase.
 2. Depressed patients who show normalization of functional connectivity between the Default Mode Network (DMN) and the Central Executive Network (CEN) after Cognitive Behavioral Therapy will demonstrate more significant symptom improvement.
- **Operationalization Path:**
 - **Brain Region Definition:** Use standard brain functional parcellation atlases (e.g., Power264, Yeo7 networks).
 - **Alignment Degree Calculation:** Use task-based fMRI data, extract time series from each network as computation vectors $\vec{v}_i$. Use existing brain structural connectivity maps (e.g., HCP data) or compute resting-state functional connectivity as estimates for connection weights w_{ij} . Substitute into the alignment degree formula for calculation.
 - **Longitudinal Design:** Measure at multiple time points (pre-, mid-, post-therapy) to examine the correlation between changes in A and improvement in clinical symptoms.

Program II: Clinical Predictive Testing of [Theorem Two: Cognitive Framework Fitness]

- **Core Hypothesis:** The baseline score calculated using the fitness formula $\text{Fitness} = (D \times E)/(R + \epsilon)$ can predict the long-term effectiveness of different treatment methods and guide therapeutic strategy selection.
- **Testable Predictions:**
 1. For patients with high framework rigidity R and low need satisfaction D (low fitness), psychoeducation alone will have limited effect. It needs to be combined with experiential therapy (e.g., Emotion-Focused Therapy) to **enhance** the D value.
 2. For patients with extremely low ecological compatibility E (e.g., severe social exclusion), individual therapy must be combined with family/social system intervention.
- **Operationalization Path:**
 - **Variable Measurement:**
 - D (Need Satisfaction): Use the "Basic Psychological Needs Scale (BPNS)" or "Psychological Well-being Scales."
 - E (Ecological Compatibility): Use the "Social Support Rating Scale (SSRS)" or "Work-Family Conflict Scale."
 - R (Framework Rigidity): Use the "Cognitive Flexibility Inventory (CFI)" or the "Openness to Experience" subscale of NEO-PI-R.
 - **Critical Threshold Calibration:** Through large-sample cross-sectional studies ($N > 1000$), determine the curvilinear relationship between Fitness and scores on standard mental health scales (e.g., SCL-90 total score), identifying the optimal discrimination threshold (e.g., the preliminary hypothesis of 0.6).

Program III: Social Network Validation of [Theorem Three: Noetic Niche Interaction]

- **Core Hypothesis:** An individual's mental health and growth are closely related to the structure of "bidirectional empowerment" within their noetic network.
- **Testable Predictions:**

1. In organizational settings, the product of an employee's perception of "individual contribution" and "network empowerment" can predict their job burnout and turnover intention.
 2. In family systems, healthy intergenerational interaction should exhibit high "resource circulation efficiency," not unidirectional extraction.
- **Operationalization Path:**
 - Use Social Network Analysis (SNA) methods to quantify an individual's centrality, structural hole position, etc., within their relational network.
 - Combine survey questionnaires to measure an individual's "perceived empowerment" and "willingness to contribute."

Open Collaboration Declaration:

We openly invite neuroscientists, clinical psychologists, sociologists, and other researchers to design specific experiments based on this research program. All formulas and thresholds in this theory (e.g., $A_c \approx 0.7$, critical fitness threshold of 0.6) are heuristic hypotheses and predictions to be tested. We look forward to their calibration, revision, or falsification through rigorous empirical research. The true vitality of a theory lies precisely in this **sustained dialogue** with the empirical world.

(Statement on Critical Thresholds)

All specific critical thresholds appearing in this paper (e.g., Inter-Brain-Region Alignment Degree $A_c \approx 0.7$, critical Cognitive Framework Fitness of 0.6) are heuristic working hypotheses based on existing literature and theoretical deduction. Their proposal aims to translate the theory into an operable, testable form, not to claim they are established facts. We explicitly state that the precise calibration of these thresholds is a core task for future empirical research. Appendix C provides preliminary measurement and calibration schemes. We openly invite and anticipate the research community to collaboratively revise and refine these parameters through cooperation.

6.3 The Dynamics of Civilization: The Eternal Game Between System Inertia and Individual Probes

Let us now introduce the ultimate proposition from *Civilizational Dynamics*. Civilization, as a macro noetic system, is forever pulled by two fundamental forces:

1. The Self-Maintaining Inertia of the System

- **Manifestation:** Tendency towards stability, solidifying existing frameworks and power structures.
- **Carrier:** The pyramidal structure's "**Life Base**."
- **Function:** Ensures efficiency in executing deterministic tasks.
- **Risk:** Overdevelopment leads to innovation suffocation and system rigidity.

2. The Innovative Probes of Individuals

- **Manifestation:** Stemming from the untamed self-organizing trends of countless individuals.
- **Carrier:** The discrete structure's "**Field of Consciousness**."
- **Function:** Explores uncertainty, introduces paradigm shifts.
- **Risk:** Disorderly **diffusion** leads to system instability.

The health of a civilization depends not on eliminating either force but on maintaining a creative **tension** between them.

Dynamical Equation: Integration of Cognitive Escape Probability at the Civilizational Level

$$P_{\text{escape}}^- = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N \frac{k_i \cdot (M_i \cdot C_i)}{A \cdot N_{\text{total}}}$$

where:

- P_{escape}^- : The society's average cognitive escape probability.
- N_{total} : Total population.
- k_i, M_i, C_i : Individual i 's cognitive liquidity, metacognitive power, cognitive dissonance.
- A : Authority of the mainstream paradigm.
- N : Number of individuals internalizing the paradigm (can be approximated as N_{total} in a monolithic paradigm environment).

When P_{escape}^- exceeds a critical threshold θ , a civilizational-level paradigm shift (phase transition) becomes possible.

6.4 The Dimensional Ascent of Psychotherapy: The Core Regulator of Civilizational Dynamics

Within this landscape, the role of psychotherapy is completely **re-envisioned** and elevated. It is no longer a mere clinical technique but the core regulator of civilizational dynamics.

Mode of Operation:

- **Receiving and Decoding Signals:** Receives early, high-frequency signals of civilizational systemic imbalance through individual suffering.
- **Repairing and Calibrating Probes:** Uses integrative techniques to repair "individual probes" damaged by systemic tension, restoring their cognitive function and creative potential.
- **Lowering the Escape Threshold:** By enhancing metacognitive power M and modulating cognitive dissonance C , reduces the difficulty of individual cognitive escape.
- **Optimizing Systemic Parameters:** Indirectly influences the civilization's cognitive liquidity k and paradigm authority A .

Therapy as Immunological Memory: Each successful treatment of cognitive escape stores a "paradigm-shift protocol" for the civilizational system. When similar structural crises reappear, these protocols can be rapidly deployed.

6.4.1 Clear Theoretical Boundaries

As a cognitive model based on Systemic Ontology, this Noetic Psychology theory has a **well-defined scope** of application and limitations:

- **Primary Scope of Application:** Functional psychological disorders and mental development issues. This includes mood disorders, anxiety disorders, personality adaptation problems, relational conflicts, meaning crises, etc. The core of these issues is the functional dysregulation of the noetic system, not structural damage.
- **Limited Application:** Psychological symptoms **associated with** organic brain damage. For cognitive-emotional changes caused by Alzheimer's disease, Parkinson's disease, traumatic brain injury, etc., this theory can serve as a useful framework for understanding psychological reactions, but treatment must be led by neurological intervention.
- **Outside Scope:** Acute phase of severe psychotic disorders (e.g., acute schizophrenic episode, manic episode of bipolar disorder). During these phases, biochemical disturbances at the

Biological Drive Layer dominate, and pharmacological intervention to stabilize the basal state takes priority.

6.4.2 Transparent Theoretical Iteration Mechanism

This theoretical system embeds self-updating capability, its evolution following a clear protocol:

- **Parameter Calibration Mechanism:** All coefficients and thresholds in the formulas (e.g., critical alignment degree $A_c = 0.7$, critical fitness threshold = 0.6) are initial hypotheses based on existing research and theoretical deduction. We openly invite the research community to calibrate them through empirical data and commit to revisions based on accumulated evidence.
- **Theorem Revision Path:** If empirical research finds systematic failure of a theorem's predictions, revision will follow this path:
 - **Step One:** Check if measurement tools and operational definitions accurately reflect the theoretical concepts.
 - **Step Two:** Examine if the theory's preconditions or scope of application have been violated.
 - **Step Three:** If the problem **indeed** lies at the theoretical level, trace back to the axiomatic system to **examine** which link in the deductive chain needs adjustment.
 - **Step Four:** Principle of minimal modification—only adjust the smallest theoretical unit necessary to explain the new data.
- **Version Control System:** We will establish a GitHub repository for the theory, implementing version control and update notes for each revision of axioms, theorems, and formulas, ensuring transparency and traceability in theoretical development.

6.4.3 Open Science Collaboration Initiative

To accelerate the empirical testing and clinical translation of the theory, we **propose** establishing a "Noetic Psychology Research Consortium" and commit to:

- **Data Sharing Standards:** Develop unified measurement toolkits and data collection protocols to promote comparability and integrative analysis of data across laboratories.
- **Open-Source Tool Development:** Develop and open-source software for calculating Inter-Brain-Region Alignment Degree, tools for assessing Fitness, and platforms for analyzing niche interaction, lowering the technical barrier to research.
- **Clinical Case Database Construction:** Establish an anonymized multi-dimensional diagnosis and treatment process database to provide real-world data for optimizing therapeutic algorithms.
- **Regular Academic Workshops:** Host an annual "Empirical Research Forum on Noetic Psychology" to report the latest **advances**, calibrate theoretical parameters, and plan collaborative research.

We firmly believe that only through such open, collaborative, and transparent scientific practice can we truly achieve psychology's historical transformation from "pre-paradigmatic fragmentation" to a "unified science." This paper is not only a statement of theory but also an invitation and launch protocol for this transformation.

6.4.4 Brief Discussion on "Cross-Cultural Applicability"

This theoretical framework is rooted in a systems-theoretic analysis of the universal structure of the human mind. Its core dynamical principles (e.g., mental hierarchical conflict, cognitive framework

fitness, bidirectional empowerment) aim to describe a cognitive functional architecture transcending specific cultures. However, culture, as a macro "noetic ecosystem," profoundly shapes the specific *content* of an individual's "cognitive framework," the *standards* for "ecological compatibility (E)," and the *forms* of "meaning narratives." Therefore, the theory's cross-cultural applicability manifests as:

- **Universal Analytical Variables:** The theory provides a set of neutral analytical variables and relational formulas (e.g., the fitness formula) that can be used to describe and compare the psychological states and adaptive processes of individuals across different cultural contexts.
- **Culture-Specific Content:** The specific measurement content, **weighting**, and health standards for the variables in the formulas (e.g., D, E, R) require localized validity testing and calibration within different cultural contexts.
- **Unified Deep Dynamics:** Despite varied surface manifestations, phenomena like cultural conflict, acculturation, and cultural change can all be analyzed through the lens of [Theorem Three: Noetic Niche Interaction] and the **Cognitive Escape Theorem**—that is, as processes of interaction and evolution between cognitive frameworks at different levels and the noetic ecosystem.

An important future research direction involves using this framework for large-scale cross-cultural comparative studies to **validate** its universality and enrich its explanation of cultural diversity.

6.5 The Ultimate Justification for Free-Will-Centrism

Now, we can provide the most profound civilizational-dynamical **justification** for the Free-Will-Centrism established in Chapter Three.

Why must we respect the client's free will, rather than imposing some "correct" way of life upon them?

Dynamical Necessity: The future of a civilization strictly depends on the **diversity** of its cognitive frameworks.

- A civilization that forces all individuals into a single paradigm will have a P_{escape}^- approaching zero, losing all options for adaptation when the environment changes.
- A civilization capable of **inclusivity** and stimulating **pluralistic** exploration will maintain a healthy level of P_{escape}^- , possessing **sustained** adaptability and innovative power.

Ecological Necessity: The diversity of free wills is a marker of health in a civilization's cognitive ecology.

- The resilience of the cognitive ecology stems from the **redundancy** of frameworks.
- The creativity of the cognitive ecology stems from the **heterogeneity** of frameworks.
- By protecting an individual's free choice, the therapist is guarding the civilization's **cognitive gene pool**.

Case Re-examination:

- The client who chooses a low-material-desire lifestyle may be exploring a **lifestyle sample** for a post-growth era civilization.
- The artist who rejects mainstream paths may be safeguarding the indispensable aesthetic and critical dimensions of civilization.
- The individual who breaks free from **family-of-origin** trauma may be contributing a template for a healthier micro-system.

The therapist's "neutrality" is, in essence, reverence for the **possibilities of civilizational evolution**.

6.6 Conclusion: An Invitation to a Paradigm Reset

This paper has completed the construction of a paradigm from foundational axioms to upper-level application. We have demonstrated that a metatheoretical framework based on Systemic Ontology can not only uniformly explain the basic structure and dynamics of the human mind but also provide clear functional positioning for all major psychological schools, thereby ending their "pre-paradigmatic" fragmentation.

The value of this work lies not in all the problems it has already solved but in the **unified research program** it initiates. It provides:

- A unified language for describing all cognitive phenomena, from brain to civilization.
- A quantifiable, operable framework for the diagnosis and intervention of mental health.
- A series of **explicit**, testable empirical research hypotheses.

We are well aware that the maturation of a paradigm requires the collective wisdom and effort of the entire scientific community. Therefore, this paper is not merely a statement of theory but an **open invitation and proposal for collaboration**. We invite neuroscientists, clinical psychologists, sociologists, and philosophers to jointly examine, challenge, revise, and expand this framework. The research programs and toolkits in the appendices are the starting point for this collaboration.

The path to a unified psychology begins with a common metatheoretical **foundation**. We have erected a signpost here. What lies ahead depends on whether we choose to proceed together.

References

- Baker, T. B., McFall, R. M., & Shoham, V. (2009). Current status and future prospects of clinical psychology: Toward a scientifically principled approach to mental and behavioral health care. *Psychological Science in the Public Interest*, *9*(2), 67–103.
- Baars, B. J. (1997). *In the theater of consciousness: The workspace of the mind*. Oxford University Press.
- Kuhn, T. S. (1962). *The structure of scientific revolutions*. University of Chicago Press.
- Luhmann, N. (1995). *Social systems*. Stanford University Press.
- Tononi, G. (2004). An information integration theory of consciousness. *BMC Neuroscience*, *5*, 42.
- von Bertalanffy, L. (1968). *General system theory: Foundations, development, applications*. George Braziller.
- Walker, W. H., Walton, J. C., DeVries, A. C., & Nelson, R. J. (2021). Circadian rhythm disruption and mental health. *Translational Psychiatry*, 11(1), 1–12.

License Statement

This work is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International License (CC BY-SA 4.0).

You are granted the rights to:

- **Share:** Copy, distribute, and transmit this work;
- **Adapt:** Remix, transform, and build upon this work (for any purpose, including commercial use);
- **Attribution:** You must give appropriate credit to the original author (Guorui He) in any use of this work, with a clear link to the original preprint;
- **ShareAlike:** If you remix, transform, or build upon this work, you must distribute your derivative works under the same license as the original.

For the full license terms, please visit: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/>

Note

High-resolution versions of the figures in this paper are available upon request from the corresponding author (Guo-Rui He, email: NoeticEcology@outlook.com).

Appendix A: Quick-Reference Guide to Core Terminology

Term	Academic Definition	Common Analogy	Clinical Example
Noesis	Information patterns that have been processed by consciousness, possess intentionality and value-ladenness, and are capable of participating in the construction of an ecosystem.	The "ecosystem" of thought, as the natural world is the ecosystem of matter.	Cultural traditions, scientific paradigms, and personal values are all forms of noesis.
Pattern Gestalt	<i>A cognitive protocol package</i> constituted by four elements: situational perception (S), response tendency (R), conceptual symbol (C), and value weight (W).	The brain's "automated script" or "habitual program" for processing specific situations.	The script of a socially anxious patient: Seeing a stranger (S) → Fear of embarrassment (R) → "I am inadequate" (C) → High anxiety weight (W).
Inter-Brain-Region Alignment Degree (A)	The degree of consensus among different functional partitions of the brain regarding which "pattern gestalt" to invoke.	Meeting efficiency among internal "departments": high consensus leads to quick decisions, disagreement leads to internal friction.	Feeling both rational agreement and emotional resistance when making an important decision is a manifestation of low alignment.
Cognitive Framework Fitness	The degree of match between an individual's cognitive framework and internal needs/external environment. Formula: $\text{Fitness} = (D \times E)/(R + \epsilon)$.	Compatibility of the mind's "operating system" with its "hardware" (physiology) and "software environment" (society).	An art-loving person suffering in an accounting role is a classic case of low fitness.
Cognitive Escape	The process by which an individual breaks through the gravitational constraints of a dominant cognitive paradigm. $F_{\text{escape}} \propto (A \times N)/M$.	Jumping out of a cognitive "comfort zone" or "inertial track" to achieve an upgrade in perspective.	Copernicus proposing heliocentrism was a successful cognitive escape from the geocentric paradigm.
Bidirectional Empowerment	The resource exchange mechanism between an individual and their social network, involving mutual provision of value and co-growth.	Healthy team relations: individuals contribute to the team, the team provides support and developmental space for individuals.	A good mentor-student relationship: the mentor guides academically, the student's new ideas inspire the mentor.

Term	Academic Definition	Common Analogy	Clinical Example
Three-Level Model of Consciousness	A synergistic architecture consisting of the Biological Drive Layer (survival monitoring), Subconscious Processing Layer (pattern recognition), and Meta-Cognitive Layer (framework operation).	The body's "alarm system," the mind's "background processor," and the decision-making "board of directors."	Increased heart rate when in danger (Biological Layer), intuitive sense of danger (Subconscious), rational assessment leading to flight (Meta-Cognitive).
Systemic Parasite	A subsystem that has betrayed its function of serving the parent system, with the sole goal of extracting system resources.	An organizational "cancer cell": consumes nutrients, contributes no function, and damages healthy tissue.	A bureaucratic institution that collects fees but provides no service; a monopolistic enterprise that stifles innovation.
Noetic Niche	An individual's specific position within the noetic ecosystem, defined by social role, cognitive attributes, and environmental demands.	The combination of "occupation + personality + living environment" within the ecology of thought.	The unique position and value of a humanities professor with critical thinking within academia.
Free Realization Degree	The quantity and quality of options that an individual's meta-cognitive layer identifies as congruent with their will-to-exist and possessing feasible executability.	How many realistic paths lead to the life you truly want to live?	A financially free individual has a higher free realization degree than someone in debt.

Appendix B: Mapping Reference between Noetic Psychology Diagnostic Framework and DSM-5

DSM-5 Category	Diagnostic	Primary Corresponding Conflict Type (Theorem 1)	Primary Fitness Shortcoming (Theorem 2)	Prioritized Psychology Sequence	Noetic Intervention	Therapeutic Stage Goals
Depressive Disorders		Type III: Inter-level Goal Divergence (Meta-cognitive goals conflict with Biological Drive state)	Extremely low D (Need Satisfaction), often with high R (Framework Rigidity)	1. Medication to stabilize Biological Drive Layer. 2. Humanistic Therapy to increase D . 3. CBT to reduce R . 4. Existential Therapy to construct meaning frameworks.		First restore energy baseline, then rebuild pathways to value.
Anxiety Disorders		Type II: Inter-level Bandwidth Mismatch (Hyperarousal in Biological Layer, dysregulated control in Meta-Cognitive Layer)	Insufficient E (Ecological Compatibility), oversensitive to environmental threats.	1. Mindfulness training to regulate bandwidth. 2. CBT to reframe threat assessment. 3. Gradual Exposure to increase E . 4. Relaxation training to regulate Biological Drive Layer.		First establish a safe observational distance, then recalibrate threat perception.
Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder		Type I: Intra-level Framework Rigidity (Excessive rigidity of specific frameworks in Meta-Cognitive Layer)	Extremely high R (Framework Rigidity), distorted D (Need Satisfaction).	1. Mindfulness to establish observer distance. 2. Exposure and Response Prevention (ERP). 3. CBT to challenge obsessive thought logic. 4. Values clarification to rebuild healthy D .		First loosen the absoluteness of the framework, then infuse flexibility.

DSM-5 Category	Diagnostic	Primary Corresponding Conflict Type (Theorem 1)	Primary Fitness Shortcoming (Theorem 2)	Prioritized Psychology Sequence	Noetic Intervention	Therapeutic Stage Goals
Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder		Composite: Type I (Trauma framework rigidity in Subconscious) + Type II (Inter-level dissociation)	Fragmented E (Ecological Compatibility), extremely high trauma-related R .	1. Stabilization techniques to establish safety. 2. EMDR to process traumatic memories. 3. Narrative Therapy to rebuild coherent meaning. 4. Systems Therapy to repair social connections.		First rebuild a sense of safety, then integrate traumatic memories.
Borderline Personality Disorder		Composite: Type II (Abnormal emotional regulation bandwidth) + Type III (Chaotic self-value goals)	Highly unstable E (Ecological Compatibility), fluctuating direction of D (Need Satisfaction).	1. DBT skills training for emotion & relationship regulation. 2. Schema Therapy to repair early maladaptive schemas. 3. Systems Therapy to optimize support network. 4. Mentalization training to enhance meta-cognition.		First acquire emotion regulation skills, then repair self-identity.
Substance Disorders	Use	Type III: Inter-level Goal Divergence (Immediate gratification vs. long-term health goals)	D (Need Satisfaction) pathologically dependent on substance; Altered E due to substance use.	1. Motivational Interviewing to clarify contradictions. 2. Behavioral substitution to establish new satisfaction paths. 3. Community support to provide a clean E environment. 4. Relapse prevention training to enhance meta-		First establish motivation for change, then construct alternative lifestyles.

DSM-5 Category	Diagnostic	Primary Corresponding Conflict Type (Theorem 1)	Primary Fitness Shortcoming (Theorem 2)	Prioritized Psychology Sequence	Noetic Intervention	Therapeutic Stage Goals
Neurodevelopmental Disorders (e.g., ADHD)		Type II: Inter-level Bandwidth Mismatch (Processing efficiency issues due to neurodevelopmental differences)	Mismatch between E (Ecological Compatibility) and environmental demands.	cognitive monitoring.		
				1. Environmental adaptation to adjust task demands. 2. Executive function training to optimize processing bandwidth. 3. Mindfulness to improve attentional regulation. 4. Strength identification to build successful D pathways.		First optimize environmental fit, then develop compensatory strategies.

Appendix C: Starter Kit for Empirical Research

C1: Streamlined Protocol for Research Program I — Quick Assessment of Dual-Network Alignment

Applicable Scenario: Preliminary validation studies in resource-limited laboratories.

Simplified Model: Prefrontal-Limbic Antagonistic Dual-Network Model.

Measurement Protocol:

- **Brain Region Selection:**
 - Prefrontal Network: Dorsolateral Prefrontal Cortex, Anterior Cingulate Cortex.
 - Limbic System: Amygdala, Hippocampus, Anterior Insula.
- **Data Acquisition:**
 - Task-based fMRI: Emotion Regulation Task (e.g., Cognitive Reappraisal).
 - Physiological Synchrony: Real-time Heart Rate Variability (HRV) recording.
- **Simplified Alignment Calculation Formula:**

$$A_{\text{simple}} = \frac{\text{Functional Connectivity Strength (Prefrontal-Amygdala) during Task}}{\text{Functional Connectivity Strength (Prefrontal-Amygdala) at Rest}}$$

- **Operational Steps:**
 1. Acquire 5-minute baseline resting-state fMRI, calculate baseline functional connectivity.
 2. Implement emotion regulation task, record concurrent task-based fMRI and HRV.
 3. Calculate changes in functional connectivity during the task.
 4. Calculate A_{simple} and perform correlation analysis with clinical improvement scale scores.

Expected Result: Treatment responders should show a significant increase in A_{simple} , positively correlated with degree of symptom improvement.

C2: Tool Combination Table for Research Program II

Disorder Type	Need Satisfaction (D) Measurement	Ecological Compatibility (E) Measurement	Framework Rigidity (R) Measurement	Symptom Assessment (Gold Standard)
Depression	Basic Psychological Needs Scale (BPNS, 21 items)	Social Support Rating Scale (SSRS, 10 items)	Cognitive Flexibility Inventory (CFI, 20 items)	Beck Depression Inventory-II (BDI-II, 21 items)
Generalized Anxiety	Difficulties in Emotion Regulation Scale (DERS, 36 items)	Perceived Stress Scale (PSS, 10 items)	Anxiety Sensitivity Index-3 (ASI-3, 18 items)	Generalized Anxiety Disorder-7 (GAD-7, 7 items)
Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder	Obsessive Beliefs Questionnaire (OBQ-44)	Dysfunctional Attitudes Scale (DAS, 40 items)	Thought-Action Fusion Scale (TAF, 19 items)	Yale-Brown Obsessive Compulsive Scale (Y-BOCS, 10 items)
Post-Traumatic Stress	World Assumptions Scale (WAS, 32 items)	Posttraumatic Growth Inventory (PTGI, 21 items)	Acceptance and Action Questionnaire-II (AAQ-II, 7 items)	PTSD Checklist for DSM-5 (PCL-5, 20 items)

Critical Threshold Calibration Method:

- Collect large-sample data ($N > 300$).
- Calculate each participant's Fitness score.
- Using SCL-90 total score as the criterion, perform ROC curve analysis.
- Determine the optimal cutoff point (maximum Youden Index).
- **Preliminary Suggested Threshold:** Fitness < 0.60 indicates high risk for maladjustment.

C3: Streamlined Questionnaire for Research Program III — Quick Assessment of Noetic Niche Interaction**Noetic Niche Health Questionnaire (Brief Version, 15 items)**

Instructions: Please rate your level of agreement with the following statements based on your experience over the past month. (1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree).

Network Empowerment Dimension (NET):

1. My primary group(s) (family/work team/friend circle) can understand and support my goals.
2. When I need help, I know who I can turn to and can receive effective assistance.
3. My environment provides the resources and opportunities I need for growth.
4. My relationships with significant others are based on mutual respect and nourishment.
5. I feel like a valued member of the groups I belong to.

Individual Contribution Dimension (CON):

6. I can contribute unique ideas or skills to my group(s).
7. My work or actions have a positive impact on others.
8. I often provide new perspectives or solutions.
9. Others actively seek my opinion or help.
10. I feel my talents are being fully utilized.

Resource Circulation Efficiency Dimension (CYC):

11. The giving and receiving between me and others is roughly balanced.
12. I feel my contributions receive appropriate recognition and **return**.
13. The rules of the group are fair and transparent, conducive to everyone's development.
14. After I help others, I can also receive help when in need.
15. The overall operation of the system makes me feel hopeful and motivated.

Scoring & Interpretation:

- **Dimension Score** = Sum of corresponding item scores / Number of items.
- **Health Standard:** Each dimension ≥ 3.5 , and difference between any two dimensions ≤ 1.0 .
- **Warning Signal:** Any dimension ≤ 2.5 , or difference between dimensions > 1.5 .